

1. Read the following case study and answer the question that follows:

Round-the-Clock Stress

Many employees find it hard to manage stress at work, but they often look forward to unwinding at home. However, with the changing nature of jobs, home is no longer the peaceful retreat it used to be. Advanced technology and the demand for 24-hour services mean that more employees are now always on call or working late-night shifts, which were once limited to factory jobs. For instance, many Walmart stores, Walgreens pharmacies, and supermarkets are open all day and night.

Similarly, at the Heartland Golf Park in Deer Park, Long Island, golfers can book a game start time as late as 3:00 AM. This late-night service became so popular that, within just three months, players were waiting up to two and a half hours for a midnight slot. Enthusiastic golfers don't seem to mind since the course is brightly lit, allowing them to play as if it were daytime.

Businesses across the country have realized that staying open beyond "normal" hours can significantly boost their profits. A research firm estimates that this strategy can increase profits by 5%, which is a big deal for businesses facing intense competition and shrinking margins.

In some cases, customer demand has driven the decision to operate round-the-clock. For example, Kinko's, a chain of photocopy shops, switched to 24-hour service because people were banging on their doors after closing time, needing urgent photocopies. One news article described Kinko's stores as hotspots for night owls, including people working on secret projects or preparing for important presentations. In Chicago, Kinko's even set up an office in a hotel lobby because international guests needed services like faxing and desktop publishing at odd hours. The hotel couldn't handle these requests, so it partnered with Kinko's to meet the guests' needs, benefiting both the hotel and its customers.

Banks have also started offering 24-hour services. In addition to widespread ATMs, some banks now allow customers to check their eligibility for car loans within 10 minutes, even late at night. Many banks also provide after-hours services like safe deposit boxes, overdraft protection, and \$1,000 credit lines—all through a simple phone call at any time.

Some critics worry that these changes may increase business costs and put more pressure on employees. Long hours or late-night shifts can lead to fatigue, burnout, and more mistakes compared to traditional 9-to-5 schedules.

Despite these concerns, about two-thirds of all U.S. workers—roughly 75 million people—do not follow a 9-to-5 work schedule, and this number is growing. Businesses operating internationally, like brokerage firms, must also adapt to unusual hours. For example, U.S.-based brokers need to work early in the morning to match Europe's stock exchange hours. By the time they finish trading on the Pacific Stock Exchange in the evening, Asia's markets are opening. Simply put, more businesses are now running 24/7, which brings with it both opportunities and the added stress of non-stop work.

Questions

(a) Identify the personality type(s) that possess the psychological resilience needed to handle the demands of emerging 24/7 operations. How might these individuals react if the organization suddenly announced that all employees must be on call 24 hours a day due to a transition to round-the-clock customer service?

(b) Discuss the various environmental sources of stress indicated in the case.

Soln: 1

personality types:-

- Positive self-evaluation
- Internal locus of Control
- High self monitoring
- Type-B personality

These types of people may handle 24/7 work better

They are more confident, adaptable & better able to stay calm.

If suddenly asked to remain on call 24 hours, they may adjust to the situation more positively while Type B individuals may handle the pressure with less impatience & stress.

Soln 2:-

The main Sources of Stress are Long working hours, Late-night shifts, being on call all the time, loss of work-life balance, Customer demands & pressure to provide 24/7 service. International work timings & cont. work can also cause fatigue, burnout & Mistakes.

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Environmental Sources of stress:-

- 1) Technological changes:- advanced technology has made employees continuously available & enabled 24-hour services.
- 2) Economic & competitive pressure:- Businesses face intense competition & shrinking profit margins, increasing pressure to operate 24/7.
- 3) Globalization:- International businesses have to work according to different time zones & global market timings.
- 4) Changing customer demands - customers increasingly expect services at any time, creating pressure for round the clock operations.